

that stores will continue to read either set for at least a while but eventually even that hope will be gone. So get ready to stockpile like it's 2099!"

Creative couponing? That's one way to put it, but it still boils down to misredemption of a coupon when a consumer is purposely using a coupon on something the coupon wasn't intended for. And when Bud Miller of the Coupon Information Center (CIC) posted informative links regarding counterfeit coupons, forum members booed and hissed in response. "Who let the coupon troll in here?" one poster asked.

Unfortunately for the coupon community, until the codes were changed to eliminate the possibility of using a family code coupon on something it isn't meant for, there would be repeat offenders who aimed to beat the system, fraudulently or not. As recently as April 2011, a couponer featured on the TLC *Extreme Couponing* show admitted to having done just that, right on national television. Legitimate couponers emailed the station, blogged about the controversy, and even created a Facebook page designed specifically for the purpose of jailing this woman for her blatant misuse of coupons. Careful perusal of her filmed purchases and a close-up of her shopping list showed she was shopping by the UPC codes, and not the product name. Versions of her earlier YouTube videos demonstrated how she routinely used coupons for products other than what they were intended for. With the potential for coupon misuse such as this, it is no wonder the manufacturers saw a need to overhaul the Universal Price Codes.

An overhaul of the price codes is just the tip of the iceberg regarding updates and changes in coupons. With the advent of the Internet in the 1990s, a whole new world opened up for coupons. Consumer Product